Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph
Hyderabad Province



Province Policy for Safeguarding Minors and Vulnerable Adults 2026

"Let the little children come to me; do not stop them; for it is to such as these that the Kingdom, of God belongs."
Mark 10: 14

"The sisters of the Society of JMJ as colleagues in the affairs of God, should treat each other with great respect."
Spirit & Charism Page.58

"Because you have been religious for so long, do not consider yourself superior to the sisters who have just recently been professed". PM 1.65



Rev Fr. Mathias Wolff SJ
Founder of the Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph

CONGREGATION OF JESUS MARY JOSEPH

HYDERABAD PROVINCE

PROVINCE POLICY FOR SAFEGUARDING MINORS AND VULNERABLE ADULTS

2026

Province Policy for Safeguarding Minors and Vulnerable Adults

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Prepared by Cong. of JMJ, Drafting Committee, Indian Provinces

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FOREWORD

With a deep sense of responsibility and faith, I am pleased to present this Safeguarding Policy of the Hyderabad Province of the Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph (JMJ). Rooted in the vision of our Founder Rev. Fr. Mathias Wolff SJ., and inspired by the compassionate love of Jesus Mary Joseph, this policy reflects our shared commitment to protect the dignity and well-being of every person entrusted to our care.

Safeguarding is not merely a document or a procedure, but it is a sacred ministry, a living expression of our vocation to channelize God's protection and healing. Each child, young person, and vulnerable adult carries within them the image of God; therefore, it is our moral and spiritual duty to ensure that their lives are nurtured in safety, respect, and love.

Through this policy, we renew our collective commitment to build communities of trust and transparency with no place for abuse like the physical, emotional, sexual, spiritual, or financial, in any form. We pledge to uphold justice for survivors, to stand by those who are wounded, and to act at all times with courage, compassion and, accountability.

As we continue our mission of formation, education, healthcare, pastoral and social services, may this policy guide our hearts and actions. Let it remind us that safeguarding is not an

additional responsibility, but an integral part of our discipleship, a concrete way of living the Gospel in truth, integrity and love.

I appreciate the strenuous efforts of Sr.Joseph Mary Vadlamudi and policy drafting committee Sr.SwarnaYeruva, Sr.Pushpy Micheal, Sr.Santhosh Mary and Sr.Saritha Prathipati for formulating the policy with relevant safeguarding measures and procedures.

I greatly acknowledge the approval of this document by Rev.Sr.Mary Karickakunnel and Council on 29th January 2026.This approval envisages us to commit ourselves to the mission of safeguarding adhering to the policies and guidelines outlined in it.

May the Spirit of wisdom and compassion accompany each of us in this sacred mission. May our communities truly become safe havens where every person can experience the tenderness of God and a hope of new life. May Jesus Mary Joseph our holy patrons, inspire us to uphold the dignity of every person. May our founder Rev. Fr. Mathias Wolff SJ continue to guide us as we serve to illuminate the lives through our apostolates.

Sr.Pauline Nusi JMJ
Provincial Superior
Hyderabad Province

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DECREE OF PROMULGATION

Following the Church's regulations regarding the abuse of minors and vulnerable adults, a policy was prepared containing the guidelines, roles and responsibilities of the commission members, and procedural rules in the event of abuse of minors or vulnerable adults and has been subjected to the approval of the Superior general and Council. They approved the policy dated **30.01.2026** and the Provincial Council of Hyderabad did the same on **02.02.2026.**

Therefore,
THE PROVINCIAL SUPERIOR,
SR.PAULINE NUSI,
WITH THE CONSENT OF HER COUNCIL,
PROMULGATES
PROVINCE POLICY FOR SAFEGUARDING MINORS AND VULNERABLE ADULTS ACCORDING TO THE TEXT APPROVED.

Seal and Signature of the Provincial Superior

Provincial - Soc. of JMJ
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PREFACE

TheSafeguarding Policy of the Hyderabad Provinceof the Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph (JMJ) is born from our deep conviction that the protection of every child and vulnerable adult is a sacred commission entrusted to us by God. Inspired by the vision of our Founder, Rev.Fr. Mathias Wolff SJ., and guided by the compassionate example of Jesus, Mary, and Joseph, we commit ourselves to ensure that all our communities and ministries are places of safety, respect, and care.

This policy provides a clear framework for safeguarding within our Province. It defines preventive measures, outlines reporting and redress mechanisms, and affirms our zero-tolerance stance towards all forms of abuse: physical, emotional, sexual, spiritual, financial, power and conscience. Rooted in the Gospel values and aligned with both Church directives(*Vos Estis Lux Mundi*, 2019; Congregational Safeguarding Framework, 2024) and the civil law (POCSO, JJ, and POSH Acts), it ensures that our safeguarding practice is both faithful and just.

The policy was developed through prayer, consultation, and collaboration among the Province leadership, the Safeguarding drafting Committee, and members engaged in formation, education, healthcare, pastoral and social ministries. It is designed to be a living document, reviewed and renewed in the light of emerging needs, best practices, and the evolving guidance of the Universal Church.

Every sister, formee, staff member, and collaborator shares in this responsibility. Together, we pledge to nurture a culture of vigilance, accountability, and compassionate care, where each person, especially the most vulnerable, can grow in dignity and trust. Through the implementation of this policy, we reaffirm our commitment to create a culture of safety, respect and accountability that permeates every level of our society.

May this policy serve as a guiding light in our mission of love and service, helping us to live the Gospel with integrity, justice, and mercy in all that we do!

Sr. Swarna Yeruva
Province Safeguarding Officer
Hyderabad Province

Table of Contents

Foreword ……..…..…i
Decree of Promulgation ……...…… iii
Preface ……..…… iv
Table of Contents ……..… vi
1. Introduction 1
2. Context of the Policy 2
3. Commitment of the Leadership 5
4. Compliance and Accountability..... 6
5. Guiding Principles of the Policy..... 8
5.1 Gospel Values 8
5. 2 Universal Principles of Safeguarding..... 8
6. Objectives 10
7. Scope of the Policy 11
8. Clarification of Terms..... 12
9. Types of Abuse 14
9.1 Abuse of Conscience 14
9.2 Abuse of Power 14
9.3 Emotional or Psychological Abuse..... 15
9.4 Physical Abuse / Corporal Punishment 15
9.5 Sexual Abuse 15
9.6 Sexual Exploitation..... 15
9.7 Sexual Harassment 16
9.8 Spiritual Abuse 16
10. Safeguarding Commission: Powers and Functions..... 16
10.1 Province Safeguarding Commission (PSC) 16
10.1.1 Composition..... 16
10.1.2 Tenure..... 17
10.1.3 Powers and Functions of the Provincial Superior .. 17

10.1.4 Powers and Functions of Province Safeguarding Officer(PSO) 18
10.1.5 Powers and Functions of PSC 18
10.2 Unit Safeguarding Commission (USC) 20
10.2.1 Composition 20
10.2.2 Tenure 20
10.2.3 Powers and Functions of Unit Safeguarding Officer (USO) 20
10.2.4 Powers and Functions of USC 21
10.3 Termination from Office 22
11. Safeguarding Framework: Prevention, Intervention, Redressal and Review 23
11.1 Creating a Safe Environment 24
11.1.1 General Recommendations 24
11.1.2 Safe Physical Environment 25
11.1.3 Safe Digital Environment 27
11.1.4 Risk Assessments and Counseling Services 28
11.1.5 Survivor Participation and Learning 29
11.2 Safe Recruitment 29
11.2.2 Criteria for Recruitment into Religious Life 31
11.3 Formation in Safeguarding 32
11.3.1 Human Formation 32
11.3.2 Religious Formation 33
11.4 Training in Safeguarding 35
11.5 Working with Communities in Communicating Safeguarding Message 37
11.5.1 Collaboration with Communities 37
11.5.2 Networking with Similar Organizations 39
11.6 Code of Conduct 40

11.6.1 General Conduct 40
11.6.2 Physical Conduct 41
11.6.3 Emotional Conduct 42
11.6.4 Conduct in spiritual Context 43
11.6.5 Financial Conduct 44
11.6.6 Digital and Media Conduct 45
11.7 Reception of Allegations 46
11.7.1 Sources of Allegation 47
11.7.2 Anonymous and Vague Allegations 47
11.8 Dealing with Suspicions, Concerns, Knowledge and Allegations 48
11.8.1 General Recommendations 48
11.8.2 Whistleblower Protection 50
11.8.3 Role of the PSO 50
11.8.4 Trauma-Informed Pastoral Care 50
11.9 Report of Abuse 51
11.9.1 General Recommendations 51
11.9.2 Reporting Structure 52
11.9.3 Procedures for Reporting to the Civil Authorities 52
11.9.4 Procedure for Reporting if the accused is the Member of the Province 55
11.9.5 Interaction with the Media 56
11.10 Dealing with the Accused 57
11.10.2 Where the Accused is not Found Guilty 57
11.10.3 Right of Appeal 57
11.10.4 Maintenance of Records 58
11.10.5 Safe Record-keeping and Data Protection 59
11.11 Redressal Mechanism 59
11.11.1 Care for the Alleged Victims and their Families 59

11.11.2 Care and Management of the Accused and the Convicted 60
11.12 Review 62
11.12.1 Accountability and External Oversight 62
11.12.2 Evaluation and Monitoring 63
12. Consequences for Non-Compliance to the Code of Conduct 64
13. Policy Declaration 65
14. Conclusion 67
Annexure-1 68
Annexure-2 70
Annexure-3 74
Annexure-4 76
References 77

1. Introduction

Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph is an apostolic, religious, international institute of pontifical right, founded by Fr. Mathias Wolff SJ in 1822.[1] It is committed to create a safe and nurturing environment for individuals in its care, through its apostolic services of Formation, Education, Health care, Pastoral,Evangelization and Social work.

This policy is intended to establish a clear standard for all members and associates within JMJ Hyderabad Province regarding their moral and legal responsibilities to treat everyone with respect, to actively prevent abuse, and to report any such cases. The province affirms that every child and vulnerable person, created in the image and likeness of God, possesses an inalienable dignity that must be respected, protected, and nurtured. In all circumstances, their safety, welfare, and holistic development shall take precedence over any institutional or reputational interest. The Province upholds a zero-tolerance toward all forms of abuse—sexual, physical, emotional, financial, spiritual, power- and commits to prevent any such occurrences.The Province is committed to foster a culture of safeguarding through creating safe environment, safe recruitment, ongoing formation, training in safeguarding, establishing code of conduct in communities and ministries. The Safeguarding framework includes intervention and redressal

[1]*Constitutions of the Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph,* art .1.

mechanism to ensure the dignity of the victims and their families. Safeguarding measures shall be regularly reviewed, strengthened and evaluated in the light of evolving Civil laws, Church directives and best practices that the mission of Christ may be carried out in truth, justice and love.

2. Context of the Policy

Pope Francis reminds us that, *"in the Confiteor, we ask forgiveness not only for the wrong we have done, but also for the good we have failed to do".*[2] In the past, the Catholic Church in India, as well as in many other parts of the world, has faced painful moments where the duty to protect children and vulnerable persons was not adequately fulfilled. These failures have brought about deep wounds and a loss of trust, which call for sincere repentance, structural reforms and a renewed commitment to safeguarding. Globally and locally, the Church policies and safeguarding frameworks are being evolved to ensure that protection of minors and vulnerable adults is not merely a protocol but an essential expression of the Gospel mission. As we continue this journey of truth, justice and healing, it is vital to move forward with courage and perseverance.

[2]Pope Francis (2023) Address of His Holiness Pope Francis to the Members of the Pontifical Commission for the Protection of Minors, p. 2. Available at: https://www.vatican.va/content/francesco/en/speeches/2023/may/documents/20230505-pontcom-tutelaminori.html(accessed 6 January 2025).

"*Even when the path forward is difficult and demanding, I urge you not to get bogged down; keep reaching out, keep trying to instill confidence in those you meet and who share with you this common cause. Do not grow discouraged when it seems that little is changing for the better. Persevere and keep moving forward.*[3]"

These words are especially meaningful for the Church in India, where diversity, complexity and vast pastoral realities exist.It challenges us to become ever more vigilant, compassionate and responsive in our mission to safeguard and make certain that every child and vulnerable adult is safe, valued and empowered within our communities.

India, which is home to the largest child population in the world, continues to face a serious and growing challenges in addressing child abuse, much of which remains unreported or inadequately addressed. The Constitution of India upholds the fundamental rights of all children and mandates the State to enact special provisions for their protection and holistic development-making sure that they grow up in environments of freedom, dignity and safety, shielded from trafficking, child labor, exploitation and all forms of abuse.[4] To operationalize this constitutional vision, a series of child protection laws and frameworks have been introduced, including the Child Labor (Prohibition and Regulation) Act 1986, Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act 2012, the Juvenile Justice

[3]Ibid.
[4]Constitutions of India, Articles 15(3), 21(A), 23, 24, 39 (E).

(Care and Protection of Children) Act 2015, and the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act 2013. These are further supported by policies and guidelines from various educational and regulatory bodies such as State Education Boards, UGC, AICTE and others. Collectively, these civil frameworks underscore the urgent need for a coordinated, proactive and preventive safeguarding approach by all citizens and institutions; particularly those working with or for children and vulnerable adults. The responsibility to recognize, respond, report and prevent abuse, lies at the very heart of safeguarding.

The Church too, having experienced the pain of children and vulnerable adults being subjected to various forms of abuse, directs all bishops and major superiors to put in place an effective mechanism to protect children and vulnerable adults. It urges us to prevent abuse and redress abuse-related issues, keeping in line with the legal framework of the country. Pope Francis, showed profound concern for the victims of clerical sexual abuse and assured them that the Catholic Church would take stringent measures to protect minors and vulnerable adults. To realize that vision, the Pontifical Commission for the Protection of Minors was established in March 2014, the purpose of which was stated by the Pope himself: "*Many painful actions have caused a profound examination of conscience for the entire Church, leading us to request forgiveness from the victims and from our society for the harm that has been caused. This response to these actions is the firm beginning for initiatives of many different types, which are intended to repair the damage, to attain justice, and to prevent, by all means*

possible, the recurrence of similar incidents in the future.[5]" Headed by Archbishop Thibault Verny,this Vatican Commission aims to help the Bishops Conferences, Religious Superiors and other bodies to evolve policies to offer safer environment for the protection of children.

3. Commitment of the Leadership

Faithful to the mandate of the Civil Law as well as the Catholic Church, the Provincial Superior as the President of the Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph, Hyderabad Province, considers it her bounden duty to promulgate a policy with clear guidelines for the protection of children and vulnerable adults.

3.1 The provincial Superior with the consent of her council endorse the province Policy for Safeguarding Minors and Vulnerable Adults.

3.2 The Provincial Superior, with the collaboration of province safeguarding commission, all superiors, heads of the institutions, directors and other designated members,ensures the implementation of this Policy

3.3 This policy is based on the Safeguarding Policy of the Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph, is a binding policy for entire Hyderabad Province.

3.4 Each superior or any person/s duly appointed on her behalf is responsible to ensure that every staff involved/associated with the JMJ sisters in the respective

[5]Pope Francis, *Letter to the People of God*, 20 August 2018.

Unit is made aware of this Policy periodically through appropriate training, workshops and awareness programs.

3.5 The Provincial Superior in consultation with the council members/superiors/heads of the institutions, and the Safeguarding commission of the province reserves the right to bring in any revisions/ amendments in this as and when required.

4. Compliance and Accountability

All members share a common responsibility to safeguard children and vulnerable adults and to respond to allegations with compassion and fairness.

4.1 All personnel affiliated to the Province, including vowed members, formees, staff, lay collaborators, and volunteers, shall formally acknowledge their commitment to safeguarding by signing a Safeguarding Compliance Declaration.

4.2 The individual affirms that he or she has read, understood, and agrees to adhere fully to the Province Safeguarding Policy, its guidelines, and safeguarding standards.

4.3 The Province shall promote an open and transparent culture that encourages acceptance of responsibility for one's actions.

4.4 Each Unit shall ensure compliance with the Congregational and Province Safeguarding Policy and review its safeguarding plan annually.

4.5 All members shall be empowered and encouraged to report safeguarding violations or concerns without fear of retaliation.

4.6 The implementation of safeguarding policies shall be regularly reviewed through effective feedback and monitoring mechanisms.

4.7 All safeguarding reports and records shall be securely documented, stored, and accessed only by authorized persons.

4.8 A review of safeguarding practices shall form part of the internal audit process of every Unit.

4.9 These declarations will be reviewed and renewed every three years or more frequently if deemed necessary due to changing legislation or policy updates.

4.10 The province, in alignment with national and state child protection laws, Church safeguarding norms, and the Congregational safeguarding framework, will initiate appropriate action including reporting to civil and ecclesiastical authorities if any JMJ member, staff, or associate:

4.10.1 Engages in behaviour that has caused or may cause harm (physical, spiritual, emotional, sexual) to minor or vulnerable adult.

4.10.2 Commits or attempts to commit a criminal offence against a minor or vulnerable adult.

4.10.3 Displays behaviour or attitudes that raise concerns about their suitability to work with or be around children or vulnerable adults.

5. Guiding Principles of the Policy

5.1 Gospel Values

As Christians, we believe that all human life is given and sustained by God himself and each person is made in God's image. Accordingly, human life is supremely sacred, and each person has worth and an intrinsic value. Jesus Christ loved and cared for everyone regardless of their position in society. The Safeguarding of children is an integral part of the Gospel message of dignity, love, justice and peace. As every person is created in the image of God, no one shall be harmed, exploited, or treated as inferior. Jesus consistently demonstrated tenderness to the weak, sick, poor, and the marginalized. Scripture commands us to emulate Jesus' example in caring for the vulnerable.

5. 2 Universal Principles of Safeguarding

Universal Principles of safeguardingare the core guiding principles and commitments that underpin the safeguardingof minors and vulnerable adults across all contexts; whether in religious settings, formation, education, healthcare, pastoralcare,evangelization or social work. These principles ensure that everyone is treated with dignity, respect, care and that the most vulnerable are protected from harm.

5.2.1 Inherent dignity and rights:Every personhas an inherent dignity and set of rights that must be respected and upheld without discrimination.

5.2.2 Best interests of the child/vulnerable person:Their safety, welfare, and holistic development shall always be of paramount consideration in decisions and deeds.

5.2.3 Zero tolerance to abuse:Abuse in any form—physical, emotional, sexual, neglect, or exploitation—is never acceptable and must be actively prevented and addressed.

5.2.4 Prevention through awareness and education:Ongoing training, awareness rising, and proactive measures are essential to identify risks and create safe environments.

5.2.5 Transparency and accountability:Institutions and individuals must act openly, follow clear safeguarding procedures, and be accountable for their actions or omissions.

5.2.6 Mandatory reporting and cooperation with authorities: All concernsand allegations of abuse must be reported promptly to the competent authorities, and relevant internal bodies, in accordance with the law.

5.2.7 Child and vulnerable adult participation:Their voices shall be heard and considered in matters that affect them, in a manner appropriate to their age, capacity, and circumstances.

5.2.8 Confidentiality with duty to protect:Information must be handled with sensitivity and confidentiality. However, never use to conceal abuse or to protect perpetrators.

5.2.9 Support for victims and survivors:Survivors and their families shall receive compassionate listening, psychological and spiritual care, and assistance toward healing and justice.

5.2.10 Continuous review and improvement:Safeguarding Policies and Practices must be regularly evaluated and strengthened in light of evolving laws, norms, and best practices.[6]

6. Objectives

This policy is to be a living, relevant document. It is to be upheld by the members, communities, ministries and all persons associated with the Province:

6.1 To protect children and vulnerable adults who are with Congregation of JMJ, Hyderabad province.

6.2 To recognize and respond to safeguarding concerns.

6.3 To ensure compliance with local, regional, and national safeguarding legislation and best practices.

6.4 To encourage a culture rooted in respect, care, dignity and Gospel values, ensuring all activities reflect a safe and welcoming environment.

[6]Pontifical Commission for the Protection of Minors – *Guidelines Template for Safeguarding* (2016, updated versions)

6.5 To enforce a firm “zero tolerance” to any form of abuse.

6.6 To ensure that all premises, programs, and activities are designed to prevent abuse and minimize risk through proactive planning and protocols.

6.7 To implement thorough background checks and vetting processes, including criminal record reviews, before anyone is placed on role involving contact with minors or vulnerable adults.

6.8 To affirm the duty to report any known or suspected incident of abuse, harassment, or exploitation immediately to the relevant authorities.

6.9 To ensure full compliance with Indian Civil Law by mandating the reporting of all suspected or alleged sexual offences against minors to designated civil authorities as required under legal statutes such as the POCSO, POSH and JJ Acts.

7. Scope of the Policy

This Policy applies to:

7.1 all members of the Congregation of JMJ Hyderabad province

7.2 formees at various levels of formation

7.3 lay collaborators

7.4 all employees and associates

7.5 volunteers, parents and visitorsinvolved in the ministries of the province.

8. Clarification of Terms

For the purpose of this document, the following terms are explained:

8.1 Abuseis anyphysical, sexual, emotional, economic or psychological actions or threats of actions that influence another person. This includes any behaviours that frighten, intimidate, terrorize, manipulate, hurt, humiliate, blame, injure, or wound someone.

8.2 Accused means a person who has been suspected of any safeguarding concern and/or against whom a complaint has been lodged.

8.3 Allegation means an unproved statement declaring that something has happened.

8.4 Childis a person under the age of 18 (regardless of cultural norms).

8.5 Complainant/Whistleblowermeans an individual who formally reports abusive behaviour to a designated person.

8.6 Congregation means the Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph.

8.7 Formators are those responsible for the training and spiritual accompaniment of formees.

8.8 Formeeis someone undergoing religious *formation.*For example, a novice, a postulant, an aspirant or a candidate in the congregation

8.9 Local Ordinary means diocesan bishop

8.10 Members those who are either temporary or perpetually professed religious in the congregation of JMJ.

8.11 Minor means the person who has not attained eighteen years of age.

8.12 Neglect means failure to meet development needs/ensure the well-being of the child/vulnerable adult and failure to protect the person from harm.

8.14 Province means the geographical area which is demarcated and assigned part of the Congregation of JMJ.

8.15 Provincial/President means the duly appointed head of the Province who usually also is the President of all the registered bodies of that particular Province.

8.16 Religious means any consecrated person in the Catholic Church who has opted to live under the three vows of Poverty, Chastity and Obedience.

8.17 Safeguarding Officer is any competent person duly appointed by the Provincial Superior.

8.18 Staff means and includes all employees, both domestic and institutional; whether on a paid or voluntary basis.

8.19 Unit means a recognized centre of the Provincethat included community and the institutions either owned, managed, or in collaboration with other organisations.

8.20 Victim means the person against whom the abuse was directed.

8.21 Volunteer means any person who gives freely of his or her time and expertise to participate in activities initiated by any Unit.

8.22 Vowed Member is any person of a religious congregation living and working with the JMJ Sisters.

8.23 Vulnerable Adultsis defined assomeone in a state of infirmity, physical or mental deficiency, or deprivation of personal liberty, which, even occasionally, limits their ability to understand or resist an offense.[7]

9. Types of Abuse

All abuse is a violation of human dignity and an abuse of power and trust. It can be intentional or through negligence, and all forms must be identified, prevented, reported, and addressed promptly.

9.1 Abuse of Conscience*:* Manipulation that disables a person's capacity to make free and informed moral decisions, often under the guise of religious obedience or spiritual direction. This kind of abuse distorts the conscience, leading the victim to confusion between moral good and evil.

9.2 Abuse of Power*:* The misuse of one's position of authority or trust to control, dominate, manipulate, exploit, or harm others. This applies to formators, superiors, spiritual directors, educators, administrators, doctors and all those who exercise power inappropriately on minors and vulnerable adults.

[7]*Vos Estis Lux Mundi*, 7 May 2019, Article 1 §2(b)

9.3 Emotional or Psychological Abuse*:* Persistent and intentional acts, verbal or non-verbal, that harm the emotional development or mental well-being of a minor or vulnerable person. This includes belittling, humiliating, ridiculing, scapegoating, threatening, isolating, intimidating, or excessively criticizing.

9.4 Physical Abuse / Corporal Punishment*:* Any act that causes physical pain and harms another person. This includes hitting, slapping, shaking, pushing, or any degrading punishment involving physical force, regardless of the degree of pain inflicted.

9.5 Sexual Abuse*:* Any sexual activity involving a minor or a vulnerable adult that they do not comprehend, cannot consent to, or to which they are compelled through force, threat, coercion, or abuse of power. It includes:

9.5.1 Sexual touching or intercourse

9.5.2 Forcing someone to witness sexual acts

9.5.3 Exposing oneself (exhibitionism)

9.5.4 Producing, possessing, or distributing child abuse images

9.5.5 Involving children or vulnerable persons in pornography or sexually explicit conversation

9.5.6 Masturbation in front of minors or vulnerable persons, or forcing them to perform or witness such acts.

9.6 Sexual Exploitation*:*Any actual or attempted abuse of a position of vulnerability, differential power or trust, for sexual purposes including, but not limited to, profiting

monetarily, socially or politically from the sexual exploitation of another.

9.7 Sexual Harassment*:* Unwanted and inappropriate sexualized conduct or language that creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive environment. It includes:

9.7.1 Verbal remarks (e.g., sexual jokes, comments on appearance, threats, blackmail).

9.7.2 Non-verbal gestures (e.g., suggestive looks, obscene signs).

9.7.3 Physical behaviour (e.g., unwelcome touching, caressing, fondling, unsolicited advances).

9.8 Spiritual Abuse*:* The exploitation or misuse of spiritual authority or religious teachings to manipulate, control, shame, or intimidate others. This includes presenting oneself as the "voice of God" in a way that harms the person's freedom and relationship with God.

10.Safeguarding Commission: Powers and Functions

10.1 Province Safeguarding Commission (PSC)

10.1.1 Composition

The Provincial Superior is the President of the Safeguarding Commission. The Provincial Superior shall set up a PSC consisting a minimum of five persons and a maximum of seven persons. It will be a good practice to include a safeguarding

officer, civil/canon lawyer, psychologist, medical officer, education officer, social worker, moral theologianand an external lay person of good repute, proven integrity and good judgment. Half of the members of the PSC shall be women.

10.1.2 Tenure

The tenure of the members of the PSC shall be three years however they could be reappointed for another term.

10.1.3 Powers and Functions of the Provincial Superior

1. The province safeguarding officer and commission are appointed by the Provincial Superior.
2. The Provincial Superior with the consent of her council approves the safeguarding policy.
3. The Provincial Superior with the help of province Safeguarding Commission (PSC) shall deal with any appeal against the decisions of the PSO/PSC in matters involving Children and Vulnerable Adults.
4. The Provincial Superior shall appoint/nominate any competent person as spokesperson to address the media as and when required.
5. Where the complaint/allegation is against a member, and when the preliminary inquiry comes to the conclusion that the allegation of abuse of Children/Vulnerable Adults is *prima facie* made out, the Provincial Superior shall take appropriate action according to the Procedural Norms for dealing with cases involving abuse of minors and vulnerable adults enlisted in the policy.

10.1.4 Powers and Functions of Province Safeguarding Officer(PSO)

1. The PSO will ensure the appointment of a Unit Safeguarding Officer (USO) at each Unit.
2. The PSO receives the complaint form from the USO and reports to the Province and the Congregational Safeguarding Officer (CSO) without delay.
3. The PSO reports to civil authorities where it is mandatory to report suspicions of risk of harm to children if it was not done by the unit safeguarding officer.
4. ThePSO will keep the Provincial Superior and theCSO updated.
5. Coordinates the PSC activities, evaluates the safeguarding activities, documentation, oversees the implementation of the policy in the province, and assessment.
6. The PSO maintains a case file and secures it in a secret archive which can be accessed only by the PSO, the Provincial Superior, and the external investigator.

10.1.5 Powers and Functions of PSC

1. The Safeguarding Commission at the Province level is the advisory board to the Provincial Superior in matters of Safeguarding.
2. The PSC does the preliminary investigation with the assistance of the USC. Further investigation is not the

responsibility of the PSC unless recommended by the Provincial Superior.

3. Receives and approves each Unit's Policy and its review.
4. Monitors the implementation of action plan of each Unit and its compliance with the policy.
5. Provides training for the USOs periodically.
6. Ensures that the safeguarding policy of province is communicated to all the stakeholders through awareness sessions and training programs.
7. Engages stakeholders in developing policies that are appropriate for the needs of the community and culture.
8. Engages the stakeholders in risk assessment and the preparation of the policies.
9. Engages the stakeholders in formulating, communicating, and implementing the safeguarding strategic action plans.
10. Develops information and communication strategies to provide the stakeholders with necessary and sufficient information, participation, implementation, and review of the policies.
11. Networks with partners who have robust safeguarding measures in place.
12. Develops communication material that is suitable for the community to disseminate the safeguarding information.
13. Ensures that the policy is available to all the stakeholders in the language of the community.
14. Develops child-friendly safeguarding material to enable the participation of the children in risk assessment,

drafting, implementation, and review of the safeguarding policy.

15. Ensures the availability of all the forms and tools on the province website.

10.2 Unit Safeguarding Commission (USC)

10.2.1 Composition

Depending on the number of institutions in a campus, the Local Superior with the guidance of USO and PSO, shall set up a USC consisting of minimum five persons and a maximum of seven persons. Half of the members of the USC shall be women. In case of smaller institutions with single or home-based activities, two or more institutions in an area/region can be clubbed for the purpose of forming the Unit.

10.2.2 Tenure

The tenure of the members of the USC shall be one year however they could be reappointed.

10.2.3 Powers and Functions of Unit Safeguarding Officer (USO)

The USO shall be the competent person duly appointed by the Provincial Superior.

1. TheUSO is competent to receive any complaint/allegation directly from the complainant.
2. USO shall forward the complaint/allegation for preliminary inquiry to the PSO.

3. The USO immediately refers the case to PSO and will not do further investigation unless recommended by the Provincial Superior.
4. The USO shall take the advice of the duly appointed USC in preparation of the report and submits the final report to the Provincial Superior.
5. The USO shall in case of sexual offence which calls for mandatory reporting or in case of an offence of criminal nature, report to the authority without delay according to the procedure prescribed by the law.
6. If any complaint/allegation of abuse, harassment/maltreatment or omission of duty is brought against the USO it shall be referred to the PSO directly.

10.2.4 Powers and Functions of USC

For the purpose of making an inquiry, the USC shall have the same powers as are vested in a civil court under the Code of Civil Procedure, when trying a suit in respect of the following matters, namely, (a) summoning and enforcing the attendance of any person (b) examining him/her on oath.

The USO shall conduct all proceedings with the help of the USC and in case of any unavoidable circumstances, the USO may designate another member of the commission to be the convenor.

1. The USC shall conduct the investigation and inquiry only when the matter is referred to it by the Provincial Superior.

2. In case of sexual abuse of minor, the accused cannot be confronted and the disclosure of the child need to be reported to the legal authorities without delay.
3. The USC only looks for the semblance of truth, gives its report and forwards the matter to PSO
4. The main functions of the USC are to create a safe environment, implement action plans, organize awareness programs, train unit members, estimate the risk assessment, collaborate with PSO, ensure compliance with the Province Safeguarding Policy.
5. The USC shall receive the documents submitted by the alleged victim/complainant and the accused and record statements from both parties.
6. The USC shall prepare a report of their findings which shall also include statements of the alleged victim and accused.

10.3 Termination from Office

10.3.1 If any complaint/allegation of abuse/harassment or maltreatment is brought against USO or any other member of the USC, it shall be submitted to the PSO directly.

10.3.2 Where the complaint/allegation of abuse or maltreatment is made against USO any other member of the USC and a case is made out from the preliminary inquiry they shall be disqualified from officiating any functions of the USC with immediate effect.

10.3.3 Where the complaint/allegation of abuse or maltreatment is proved against the USO or member of the USC, she/he shall cease to hold her/his office and shall be subject to the civil law of the country(jurisdiction)and the respective office shall be filled by another person appointed by the President.

10.3.4 Where the complaint/allegation against the USO or any member of the USC, is proved false and baseless, they shall resume their office as the USO or the member of the USC.

11. Safeguarding Framework: Prevention, Intervention, Redressal and Review

This framework articulates the Congregation's comprehensive approach to safeguarding, grounded in the dignity of the human person and the Gospel call to protect the most vulnerable. It outlines the structures and processes through which safeguarding is ensured, integrating preventive measures, timely and appropriate responses to concerns, just and compassionate redressal mechanisms, and ongoing review for accountability and improvement. Together, these four pillars reflect the Congregation's commitment to creating safe environments, upholding justice, promoting healing, and ensuring transparency in accordance with the norms of the Universal Church and obligations of the Civil law

11.1 Creating a Safe Environment

Creating a safe environment for children and vulnerable adults is a core value in safeguarding. It involves proactive planning, appropriate policies and a culture of vigilance to ensure everyone is protected from abuse or neglect.

11.1.1 General Recommendations

1. Promote a culture of respect, inclusion, and listening.
2. Ensure all voices are heard—take concerns seriously.
3. Empower children and vulnerable adults to speak up by teaching them about safe and unsafe behaviour.
4. Educate children, youth, and vulnerable adults on their rights, personal safety, and their approach to raise concerns.
5. Encourage a culture of openness where questions and complaints are taken seriously.
6. Each Unit shall have a written whistle-blowing procedure that enables safe reporting of suspected abuse, unethical behaviour, or safeguarding risks without fear of retaliation.
7. Each Unit shall maintain a clear and written complaints procedure for receiving, responding to, and documenting safeguarding concerns.
8. The Units shall regularly assess risks and hazards in all programmes, institutions, and activities involving children and vulnerable adults.

9. Conduct awareness programs and life-skills sessions to build confidence, self-esteem, and assertiveness among students.
10. Encourage student councils or peer mentoring groups to promote respectful relationships and mutual accountability.
11. Every Unit shall establish a Safeguarding Office with at least two legally appointed persons, one of whom shall be a qualified lay associate.
12. The Province shall ensure adequate human, financial, and infrastructural resources for the effective implementation of safeguarding measures in every Unit.
13. Each Unit shall have specific policies and practices to protect elderly members from abuse, neglect, or exploitation.
14. Ensure that social work settings are physically and emotionally safe, with private spaces for confidential conversations.
15. Advocate for policies and practices that address the root causes of abuse and promote social justice.
16. Promote open dialogue without fear of retaliation.
17. Strictly adhere to applicable laws and ensure the effective implementation of all policies mandated by the government in all ministries - health, education, social services, pastoral care, and evangelization.

11.1.2 Safe Physical Environment

1. Ensure physical environments are secure and supervised.

2. Ensure supervision in all child/vulnerable adult activities.
3. Establish open and visible meeting spaces.
4. Maintain safe transportation procedures.
5. Provide accessible safeguarding information (e.g., posters, helpline numbers, and policies in simple language).
6. Obtain written informed consent from parents/guardians and from the child too, if age-appropriate, keep signed consent forms safely filed for accountability.
7. Protect the child's identity by not sharing personal details that can identify the child such as full name, address, school, contact details, daily routine.
8. Maintain open, inclusive, and child-centered spaces where students feel respected, heard, and protected.
9. Ensure classrooms, playgrounds, dormitories, and laboratories are designed and monitored to prevent isolation or unsupervised interactions between adults and minors.
10. Display child helpline numbers and safeguarding posters in visible areas.
11. Create child-friendly complaint boxes or help desks for confidential reporting.
12. Maintain appropriate student–staff ratios in classrooms, hostels, and extracurricular programs.
13. Heads of Institutions must conduct regular supervision rounds in hostels, classrooms, and recreational spaces.

14. Install surveillance cameras in common and public areas (not in dormitories, bathrooms, or counseling rooms) to enhance accountability.
15. Extra vigilance shall be exercised for individuals who are differently- abled, indigenous, migrant, orphaned, or lacking legal guardianship.

11.1.3 Safe Digital Environment

The Province recognizes that safeguarding extends to the digital and online environment and commits to ensure safe digital environment.All members, staff and volunteers shall adhere to a Digital and Social Media Code of Conduct, which includes:

1. Responsible and respectful online communication.
2. Prohibition of private, unmonitored communication with minors or vulnerable adults through social media, messaging apps, or video calls.
3. Restrictions on sharing personal data, photos, or videos of minors without written consent of parents/guardians and approval from the Head of the Institution.
4. The Province shall periodically review online safety risks, AI-generated content, and new technologies to ensure data protection and cyber-safetyof all beneficiaries.
5. Ensure respect and dignity by using the images that portray children in apositive, respectful, and dignified way**.**

6. Ensure photos are used on secure platforms with proper privacy settings.
7. Parental consent is required for any photography, video recording, or publication involving children.
8. Be mindful of cultural, religious, and community norms regarding photography and sharing of children's images.
9. Obtain consent from local authorities if required by law or custom.
10. Provide ongoing training to members and associates on ethical digital behaviour, online boundaries, and responsible social media use.
11. Promote awareness of cyber bullying, online grooming, and digital exploitation, ensuring safe reporting channels among the children and vulnerable adults.
12. Obtain consent before taking or sharing images or personal information.
13. Use group rather than individual photos where possible.
14. Staff shall not engage in private online communication (e.g., personal messaging or video calls) with minors.

11.1.4 Risk Assessments and Counseling Services

1. Each educational institution shall appoint or have access to a trained counselor or psychologist to support students emotionally and psychologically.
2. Provide confidential and accessible counseling services for students who face abuse, bullying, or distress.
3. Encourage staff to refer students showing signs of emotional or behavioural distress for early intervention.

4. Regular psychological evaluations and risk assessments shall be conducted for personnel engaged in ministries involving minors or vulnerable adults.Such assessments shall promote well-being, boundary awareness, and suitability for ministry, while ensuring confidentiality.

11.1.5 Survivor Participation and Learning

The Province commits to listening to the voices of survivors and families affected by abuse.

1. Use anonymous feedback, consultations, or survivor-representative groups to enhance policy relevance and pastoral responsiveness.
2. Learn from survivor experiences to enhance ongoing formation, prevention, and redressal practices.

11.2 Safe Recruitment

All reasonable steps shall be taken during recruitment to ensure that no person who may pose risk to children or vulnerable adults is admitted, appointed, or engaged in any capacity.

1. Recruiters shall be trained in safe recruitment practices.
2. Recruiters shall demonstrate safeguarding awareness and risk identification skills.
3. Safeguarding requirements shall be included in all recruitment materials.
4. Job descriptions and contracts shall clearly state safeguarding responsibilities.

5. Interviews shall include safeguarding-related questions.
6. Applicants' attitudes, boundaries, and suitability shall be assessed.
7. Persons with a history of abuse or violence shall not be recruited.
8. Applicants shall demonstrate conduct consistent with safeguarding values.
9. Applicants shall complete safeguarding self-declaration forms.
10. A signed consent form confirming compliance with the safeguarding policy and relevant laws shall be submitted.
11. Police verification and clearance certificates shall be obtained.
12. At least two references shall be obtained and verified.
13. A recruitment checklist shall confirm completion of all safeguards.
14. Mandatory safeguarding induction shall be completed within one month.
15. The safeguarding policy of the Unit shall be provided at appointment.
16. Safeguarding behaviour shall be monitored during probation.
17. Feedback may be sought from supervisors and persons in care.
18. All safeguarding and recruitment records shall be documented.

11.2.2 Criteria for Recruitment into Religious Life

Recruiting formees according to Church documents on safeguarding involves integrating both vocational discernment and safeguarding of minors and vulnerable adults. The Catholic Church emphasizes that religious communities must ensure that candidates are not only spiritually and theologically suitable but also psychologically, emotionally and morally fit, especially in light of safeguarding concerns.

1. Formee must demonstrate sound moral character, emotional balance [8] and the ability to live celibate chastity with integrity.[9]
2. Psychological assessment is strongly recommended before admission.[10]
3. No known history of abuse, misconduct with minors or vulnerable adults, or serious behavioural concerns.[11]
4. Formee with certain irregularities (e.g., psychic illness, attempted homicide/suicide etc.) are refrained from ordination.[12] The same applies to all candidates who aspire to enter religious life.
5. Obtain written references and comprehensive background checks particularly from superiors, if the

[8] *CICLSAL* Circular (2015)
[9] *Ratio Fundamentalis*, §95,*Canon 642*
[10] *Guidelines for the Use of Psychology in the Admission and Formation of Candidates to the Priesthood* (2008),canon120,
[11] *Vos Estis Lux Mundi*, Art. 1–3
[12] *Code of Canon Law*, canon 1041

formee is from the other congregation.[13] Leaders must ensure careful vetting and report concerns.[14]

6. The formee shall demonstrate ability to respect boundaries, pastoral sensitivity, and understand safeguarding norms.
7. Formee must commit to ongoing safeguarding formation from the start of the postulancy or novitiate.

11.3 Formation in Safeguarding

11.3.1 Human Formation

Safeguarding shall remain integral to all ongoing formation, leadership training, and apostolic planning. Members are encouraged to promote a culture of care, accountability, and transparency in every environment where they serve. The Province reaffirms that safeguarding is not merely a policy but an enduring expression of Christ's compassion and justice.

1. Safeguarding formation shall include regular human formation sessions focusing on physical, emotional, psychological, and spiritual integrity in relation to self, others, and God.
2. Members and associates shall be empowered through formation to think critically, speak assertively, and act justly in all situations.

[13] *CICLSAL* Circular (2015)
[14] *Vos Estis Lux Mundi*, Art. 7

3. Formation programs shall promote synodality by fostering active listening, shared discernment, and participatory decision-making at all levels.
4. Formation shall emphasize healthy relationality, enabling members to recognize and respect the inherent dignity of every human person, including themselves.
5. Attitudinal formation shall be prioritized to cultivate a sustained culture of care, respect, and responsibility.
6. Members shall be trained to recognize vulnerability and dignity as inherent to all persons and to respond with compassion in all circumstances.
7. Compliance with the Safeguarding Code of Conduct shall be ensured through quality initial and ongoing formation.
8. Leadership formation shall be strengthened to ensure mature, responsible, and ethical administration at all levels of the Province.

11.3.2 Religious Formation

Appointing formator[15] in religious formation houses requires strict adherence to safeguarding principles outlined in the Church documents. Formators are entrusted with shaping future religious and must model integrity, emotional maturity, and a deep commitment to creating a safe environment for all, especially minors and vulnerable adults.

[15]Those responsible for the training and spiritual accompaniment of formees

1. All formators must model and uphold the safeguarding values of the Church as a non-negotiable part of their ministry.
2. No one may be appointed formator without undergoing adequate safeguarding training.
3. Organize regular workshops on abuse prevention, boundaries, power dynamics, consent, and respectful relationshipsin formation program.
4. Encourage a culture of transparency and accountability. Silence or clericalism has no place in religious houses.[16]
5. Formators must be emotionally stable, self-aware, and capable of maintaining healthy boundaries.
6. All formators should be trained in safeguarding policies and recognize the dynamics of abuse and power.[17]
7. Guard against abuse of conscience and spiritual authority.
8. All leaders must take responsibility toprevent and address abuse in formation houses.[18]
9. Institutes must verify the suitability of individuals placed in positions of formation or leadership.[19]

[16] Congregation for Institutes of Consecrated Life societies of apostolic life, 2019
[17] *CICLSAL Circular Letter on Safeguarding* (2019)
[18] *VELM* Art. 1–3
[19] *VELM* Art. 5

10. Mandate thorough documentation and cooperation among thecongregations to prevent recycling of problematic individuals.[20]
11. Integratetheology of the body, dignity, and chastity into formation programs.
12. Formee must be educated in safeguarding and be formed in "a culture of care."[21]
13. Every religious house and formation program must include safeguarding education.[22]
14. The formation house must be equipped to supervise and support candidates responsibly.
15. Province shall not accept candidates unless they have the infrastructure for proper formation and supervision.[23]

11.4 Training in Safeguarding

Safeguarding training shall equip members and personnel with the knowledge and skills to prevent abuse, manage allegations, and respond compassionately to victims. Safeguarding training shall focus not only on awareness but also on developing appropriate attitudes and practical skills.

1. Provide mandatory safeguarding training for all staff and volunteers on this Policy every year as part of the ongoing training program at the Unit level[24].

[20] *VELM* Art .7
[21] *Ratio Fundamentalis*, §181
[22] *CICLSAL Circular* (2019)
[23] *CICLSAL* Circular(2015)

2. Personnel involved in ministerial settings shall receive role-specific safeguarding education.
3. Safeguarding training should address boundary awareness, abuse prevention, and power dynamics.[25]
4. Specialized orientation on child protection shall be provided for those working directly with the children.
5. Provide mandatory safeguarding training for leaders, and all members.
6. Include topics such as recognizing signs of abuse, reporting mechanisms, appropriate boundaries, and safe digital/media practices.
7. Offer regular refresher training to maintain awareness and vigilance.
8. Train members and the associates to identify grooming behaviour and early warning signs.
9. Staff and members shall receive inclusive safeguarding training on communication, consent, and accessibility to ensure dignity and participation of all persons.
10. Members of Safeguarding Commissions at Unit and Province, shall receive advanced training in knowledge, attitudes, and skills to deal with victims, secondary victims, and alleged perpetrators.
11. All formees in formation shall receive age- and role-appropriate safeguarding training.

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[24] See Annexure No. 2
[25] Episcopal Conference Guidelines (e.g., CBCEW, USCCB) ,canon §127,

12. Ensure mandatory safeguarding training for members, clergy, religious, lay people, catechists, and volunteers associated with JMJ, Hyderabad Province.
13. Provide specialized safeguarding training for those entrusted with receiving, reporting, and responding to allegations.
14. Train the personnel in Health apostolate in the de-escalation techniques (NIH).

11.5 Working with Communities in Communicating Safeguarding Message

11.5.1 Collaboration with Communities

Implement community-based programs targeting social and environmental factors that contribute to crime, including youth development programs, substance abuse prevention, and initiatives focused on strengthening community cohesion.

1. The Units shall promote sustained public awareness on the causes and consequences of crime, the importance of victim support, restorative justice approaches, and safeguarding principles.
2. Conduct awareness initiatives through regular training programs, parent–teacher meetings, and orientation programs for all stakeholders.
3. These initiatives shall include education on recognizing signs of abuse, safe and responsible use of media, reporting mechanisms.

4. Encourage transparent communication between families and institutions to foster a shared responsibility for safety.
5. Encourage Communities and stakeholders for active participate in crime prevention initiatives and safeguarding processes.
6. Involve stakeholders in the development, implementation, risk assessment, monitoring, and periodic review of safeguarding policies and action plans.
7. Develop safeguarding measures in a manner that is appropriate to the needs, culture, and context of the local community, ensuring shared ownership and accountability.
8. Integrate age-appropriate safeguarding education in the curriculum to help children understand personal boundaries, safe and unsafe touch, and appropriate ways to seek help.
9. Develop child-friendly safeguarding materials to enable children to participate meaningfully, in safeguarding risk assessments, policy development, implementation, and review.
10. Provide user-friendly safeguarding information for vulnerable adults, with due consideration given to special needs, and varying levels of capacity.
11. Design material to support informed participation, protection, and access to reporting and support mechanisms.

12. Communicate Safeguarding Policy, together with all relevant forms, tools, and action plans, to all stakeholders through effective and regular information and communication strategies.
13. The Safeguarding Policy shall be made available in the local language(s) of the community.
14. Publish the Safeguarding Policy and all related forms and tools on the official website of the Province or Unit to ensure transparency, accessibility, and ongoing review.

11.5.2 Networking with Similar Organizations

The Province shall network and collaborate with organisations and partners that have strong and effective safeguarding systems in place.

1. Foster strong relationships between law enforcement, mental health professionals, and community members to identify and address local issues, build trust, and promote collaboration.
2. Collaborate with other organizations, including NGOs, government agencies, and research institutions, to leverage expertise, share resources, and enhance the reach and impact of interventions.
3. Establish platforms and mechanisms for exchanging best practices, lessons learned, and research findings to improve programming and policy advocacy.
4. Develop clear agreements outlining roles, responsibilities, expectations, and goals for each

partnership to ensure effective collaboration and avoid duplication of effort.

5. Unite efforts to advocate for policy changes and funding allocations that support comprehensive crime prevention, victim support, and rehabilitation initiatives.
6. Before assigning or transferring any member to another province, country, or collaborative ministry, a safeguarding clearance certificateshall be obtained and shared confidentially with the receiving authority.
7. Mutual cooperation between JMJ Indian provinces shall ensure continuity of safeguarding standards and information sharing in good faith.

11.6 Code of Conduct

Code of Conduct affirms our shared responsibility to protect the dignity, safety, and rights of all, especially children and vulnerable adults, through integrity, accountability, and respect. Adherence to these standards is mandatory and reflects our commitment to Gospel values.

11.6.1 General Conduct

1. All members shall comply with the Safeguarding Policy and all applicable civil and canonical laws.
2. Every person shall be treated with dignity and respect, without discrimination of any kind.
3. Members shall not exploit professional, counselling, or pastoral relationships for personal benefit.

4. Refrain from performing the tasks that children or vulnerable adults can safely do themselves.
5. Maintain healthy boundaries in all pastoral, educational, and caregiving roles.
6. Report any suspicion or violation of this Code immediately to the appropriate authority.

11.6.2 Physical Conduct

1. Corporal punishment and all forms of physical abuse are forbidden.
2. Physical contact with children or vulnerable adults shall be appropriate and culturally sensitive.
3. Inappropriate touching, including kissing, hugging, fondling, rubbing, or similar behaviour, is prohibited.
4. Sexual advances, sexual harassment, or any form of inappropriate physical contact are strictly prohibited.
5. Members shall not meet children or vulnerable adults alone in closed or unobservable spaces.
6. Children or vulnerable adults shall not be taken to personal living areas.
7. Private transportation of children or vulnerable adults shall be avoided unless absolutely necessary and formally approved.
8. Grooming through gifts, privileges, or special attention is not permitted.
9. Alcohol, tobacco, drugs, or intoxicants shall never be given to children or vulnerable adults.

10. Members shall not suggest or encourage inappropriate behaviour or relationships with children or vulnerable adults.

11.6.3 Emotional Conduct

Behaviours that could cause emotional damage often undermine a person's sense of safety, self-worth, or ability to trust. These can occur in family, school, workplace, community, or online settings.

1. Members and associates shall listen attentively and respond respectfully to expressed concerns and emotions.
2. Obsessive, dependent, or compulsive relationships shall be avoided at all times.
3. Members or associates shall not use language or behaviour that humiliates, shames, degrades, or emotionally harms a child or vulnerable adult.
4. Persistent or harsh criticism that focuses on faults rather than constructive feedback is not permitted.
5. Members or associates shall not manipulate emotions through guilt-tripping, blame, emotional blackmail, or by controlling another person's choices, relationships, or independence.
6. Refrain from excluding or isolating a person from a group, spreading rumours, gossip, or damaging a person's reputation.
7. Creating exclusive "in-groups" or "out-groups" that divide the community is not permitted.

8. Refrain from breaching privacy and confidentiality except in case of risk of harm to the victims/clients.
9. Refrain from threatening abandonment, withdrawal of care, or sudden loss of support to the minors and vulnerable persons.

11.6.4 Conduct in spiritual Context

1. Members have a duty to protect the vulnerable and uphold truth, justice, and accountability within the faith community.
2. Respect the faith, conscience, moral freedom, and spiritual dignity of every person.
3. Religious authority shall never be used to control, manipulate, shame, threaten, or dominate others.
4. Refrain from using scripture, faith, or God's name to force obedience, silence questions, or justify harmful actions.
5. Refrain from claiming spiritual superiority, special revelation, or unquestionable authority over others.
6. Refrain from instilling fear, guilt, or threats of divine punishment to coerce religious practice or compliance.
7. Spiritual guidance shall emphasise mercy, compassion, love, and truth. Encourage healthy questioning, critical reflection, personal prayer, and freedom of faith.
8. Refrain from condemning honest doubts, struggles, or questions.

9. Respect personal boundaries and refrain from intruding every aspect of a person's life under the pretext of spiritual authority.
10. Hypocrisy, including preaching values not practised, or defending wrongdoing within the community, is forbidden.
11. Members shall respond to spiritual needs with care, especially during times of crisis or vulnerability.
12. Withholding sacraments, blessings, or spiritual support as a form of punishment or control is prohibited.
13. Clericalism and hierarchical domination shall not be promoted in any form.

11.6.5 Financial Conduct

1. Financial dealings with children and vulnerable adults shall always be transparent, ethical, and in their best interest.
2. Members shall not coerce, pressure, deceive, or manipulate anyone into signing financial documents or making financial decisions they do not fully understand.
3. Withholding information, making false promises, or misrepresenting one's role or authority for financial gain is prohibited.
4. Abuse of trust, position, power of attorney, or religious or emotional influence for personal or institutional financial benefit is forbidden.
5. Members shall not access bank accounts, assets, or property without clear consent and legal authorisation.

6. Pressuring individuals or families to give money, property, loans, or donations is not permitted.
7. Repeated requests for loans, guilt-tripping, or isolating a person from family or financial advisers for financial control are prohibited.
8. Personal finances and institutional or client funds shall never be mixed.
9. Members managing another person's finances must act responsibly, keep accurate records, and maintain proper receipts and documentation.
10. Neglecting financial duties, failing to pay bills deliberately, or making risky investments without consent is not allowed.
11. Fraud, theft, forgery, skimming of funds, overcharging, or misuse of assets is strictly forbidden.
12. Selling fake investments, engaging in pyramid schemes, or gambling with someone else's money is prohibited.
13. Members shall ensure accountability and transparency in all financial matters and submit to appropriate review when required.

11.6.6 Digital and Media Conduct

1. Technology, electronic devices, and social media shall be used responsibly.
2. Images and personal data of children or vulnerable adults shall be handled with confidentiality and respect.
3. Prior and informed consent must be obtained before photographing or filming.

4. Images shall present children and vulnerable adults in a dignified and truthful manner.
5. Grooming, sexting, or possession of abusive or indecent digital material is strictly prohibited.
6. File names and digital storage shall not reveal identifying personal information.
7. Heads of institutions and their delegates are responsible for ensuring a safe environment and addressing violations through a clear redressal process.
8. Photographing or filming children or vulnerable adults in nude, partially clothed, or undignified situations is prohibited.
9. Sexually explicit, pornographic, or morally inappropriate materials shall not be displayed or shared in any form.
10. All relationships must maintain proper personal and professional boundaries.

Any violation of the code of conduct by the member or the associate is to be reported immediately to the designated authority.

11.7 Reception of Allegations

The Hyderabad Province recognizes that allegations of abuse or misconduct involving minors or vulnerable adults may surface in various ways. It is the duty of the PSO and PSC to receive, assess and respond to such reports with seriousness, discretion and pastoral sensitivity.

11.7.1 Sources of Allegation

Allegations may arise through a variety of channels, including but not limited to:

1. Direct reports from the alleged victim, their family members, legal guardians, or other concerned individuals, either verbally or in writing.
2. Observations by the Provincial Superior or Church authority during their pastoral or supervisory responsibilities.
3. Referrals by civil authorities as per the mechanisms established in local or national legislation.
4. Media reports, including digital and social media platforms.
5. Third-party disclosures, such as individuals who may have heard or witnessed concerning behaviour.

11.7.2 Anonymous and Vague Allegations

1. Anonymous reports while not encouraged must not be automatically dismissed. Such reports must be received with caution, and an initial review should assess their plausibility and potential risk.
2. Allegations lacking clear details (e.g., names, dates, or locations) should still be appropriately evaluated.
3. Any report suggesting possible harm to a minor or vulnerable adult warrants attention, especially if the concern is credible or recurring.

11.8 Dealing with Suspicions, Concerns, Knowledge and Allegations

11.8.1 General Recommendations

1. All allegations, suspicions, and concerns of abuse shall be taken seriously and acted upon in accordance with both Civil Law and Canon Law.
2. Each Unit shall appoint trained and supportive personnel skilled in receiving allegations, reporting them to the appropriate authorities, and assessing related safeguarding risks.
3. Clear procedures and systems shall be established in every Unit for recording, reporting, and responding to concerns, suspicions, and allegations of abuse.
4. Ensure every institution has a USO and a designated Internal Complaints Committee ICC as per law.
5. Clearly display contact information of the USO and helpline numbers.
6. All disclosures of abuse must be recorded and reported immediately according to the Province Safeguarding Policy and Indian civil law (e.g., POCSO, JJ Act).
7. Strict confidentiality must be maintained throughout the process.
8. All allegations and concerns shall be reported in compliance with the applicable civil laws and statutory guidelines of the country where the ministry is carried out.

9. Where civil laws or procedures are inadequate or not in the best interest of the victim, the Province shall follow best practices that prioritise the safety and well-being of the victim.
10. Restorative justice procedures shall be made available for cases that fall outside the scope of formal legal investigation, where appropriate.
11. Personnel appointed to facilitate restorative justice processes shall be suitably trained and experienced.
12. Appropriate disciplinary action shall be taken in cases where allegations are found to be deliberately false, in accordance with law and due process.
13. Professional and accurate records shall be maintained throughout the process, recognising that such records may be required in legal or canonical proceedings.
14. The USO listens to the complainant with respect, empathy, and confidentiality, ensuring the person feels heard and safe.
15. The allegation is documented using the official reporting form, capturing details such as the date, location, names of involved parties, and any relevant circumstances to ensure a thorough preliminary assessment.
16. The complainant is informed of the reporting and investigative process, both verbally and in a written, easy to understand language.
17. Obtain informed consent from the complainant before proceeding. However, in cases of mandatory reporting,

the report must be submitted to authorities regardless of consent.

11.8.2 Whistleblower Protection

1. Any individual who reports abuse or safeguarding violations in good faith shall be protected from retaliation or discrimination.
2. The Province shall provide anonymous and confidential reporting channels, digital and physical.
3. All whistleblower reports shall be logged, acknowledged, and followed up with transparency and fairness.

11.8.3 Role of the PSO

1. The PSO or her representative ensures a pastoral and trauma-informed approach when engaging with the alleged victim, offering support, care, and appropriate referrals.
2. She ensures that the province safeguarding policy is strictly followed and that there is no retaliation, silencing, or cover-up at any stage of the process.

11.8.4 Trauma-Informed Pastoral Care

1. All pastoral and educational ministries shall adopt a trauma-informed approach, prioritizing the psychological and spiritual well-being of survivors.
2. Interviews and investigations must avoid re-traumatization and be conducted with empathy and confidentiality.

3. Qualified counsellors and mental-health professionals shall be available for immediate and long-term support.

11.9 Report of Abuse

11.9.1 General Recommendations

The Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph, Hyderabad Province upholds a zero-tolerance policy regarding abuse. Reporting any form of abuse is both a moral and legal obligation, especially when involving minors or vulnerable adults.

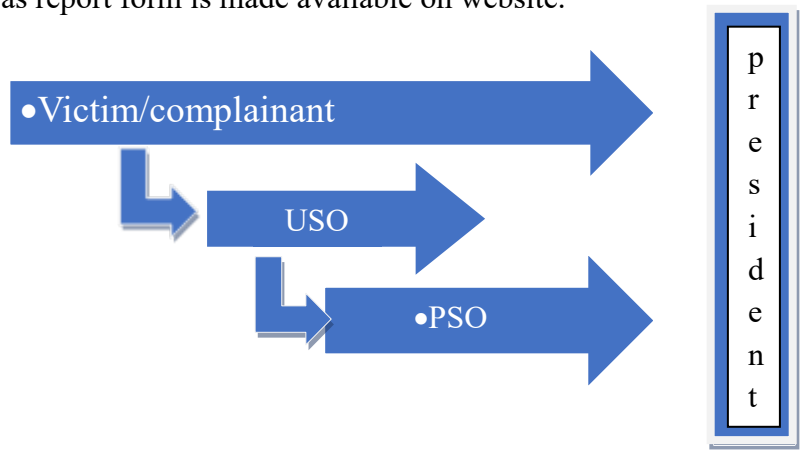
1. All members, the child victim, parents, guardians, teachers, doctors, and caregivers, members of the public who suspects child abuse can report it.
2. Formees must report any suspected or known abuse immediately to the Local Superior or USO.
3. Reporting by a child or vulnerable adults can be either oral or written.
4. Anonymous reports or letters must also be investigated appropriately.
5. All have the legal obligation to report. Any person who fails to reports can be sanctioned.[26]

[26]According to Indian law (POCSO Act & Cr PC, JJ Act), any person aware or suspicious of sexual offences against minors must inform:

1. Notwithstanding anything contained in the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973, any person (including child), who has apprehension that an offence under this act is likely to be committed or has knowledge that such an offence has been committed, he shall

11.9.2 Reporting Structure

In case of abuse by any member of the institute, the associate or the victims may report to the designated safeguarding officer at Unit level. They can also bring the complaint before the PSO or the president. The victim is free to lodge a complaint online as report form is made available on website.



11.9.3 Procedures for Reporting to the Civil Authorities

When there's an allegation of abuse at an institutional setting, a standard, legally sound process should be followed.

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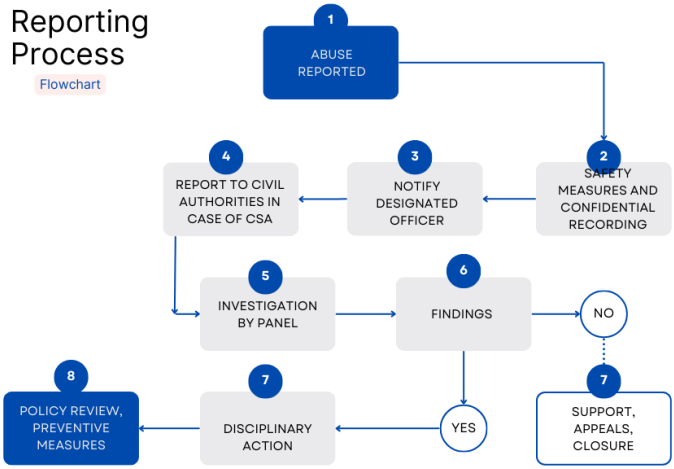
provide such information, (i) to the Special Juvenile Police Unit, (ii) the local police.

2. Any person who fails to report can be sanctioned.
3. Any person, being in-charge of any company or an institution (by whatever name called) who fails to report the commission of an offence under sub-section (1) of 19 in respect of a subordinate under his control, shall be punished with imprisonment for a term which may extend to one year and with fine.

Irrespective of the status of the accused, the civil authorities should be reported in case of sexual abuse of the minors.

1. Ensure the safety of alleged victim, separate them from the accused, and provide support (e.g. counselling).
2. Maintain strict confidentiality for both the alleged victim and the accused.
3. Document the incident accurately: this includes thedate, time, location, what was said/done, names of witnesses, in the alleged victim's own words. Sign and date the record.
4. Report internally as soon as possible, external reporting is legally mandatory in the case of child abuse. Failure to report child abuse is punishable.
5. In case of a minor inform the designated Child Protection Officer or Committee, and within 24 hours notify the police or Special Juvenile Police Unit under POCSO/JJ Act.
6. The USC assesses if there's enough information to open a formal inquiry; for schools, a response USC should convene within 24 hours.
7. Prepare a detailed report with findings and recommended disciplinary action.
8. In case of minors, share with Child Welfare Committee (CWC) and police; also consider psychological support for the victim.
9. In case of adults, the USC submits findings to PSO, who recommends actions—ranging from counseling, suspension, demotion, up to termination or expulsion.

10. Keep the alleged victim and their family informed about progress and outcomes. Offer ongoing support and counselling for all affected.
11. If the alleged victim or their guardian is unsatisfied, they have the right to appeal to a higher authority or escalate to police/ courts.



11.9.4 Procedure for Reporting if the accused is the Member of the Province

Procedural rules for reporting the abuse and dealing with allegations are followed from the congregational safeguarding policy.[27]

1. When an allegation of abuse by a member, formee, or an associate is received, the Provincial Superior in collaboration with the PSO, must act with urgency, compassion and fidelity to both Church and civil law**.**
2. The process prioritizes the safety and well-being of the minor, often requiring the accused to be removed from ministry and potentially from proximity to minors or vulnerable persons.
3. The canonical proceeding need to be paused during the period of investigation, not to interfere with the civil authorities.
4. Even if the civil court dismisses the case due to lack of evidence, the canonical proceedings could be resumed.
5. If the abuse results in public scandal, the same must be reported to the bishop.
6. If the accused is a religious or a cleric, the Provincial Superior informs the Local Ordinary of the respective diocese.

[27]Congregational policy for safeguarding minors and vulnerable adults 2024, p. 41-47, https://congregationjmj.org//storage/media/jmj-safeguarding-policy.pdf

7. After preliminary assessment, the Provincial Superior sends the report with a *votum* to the Superior General.
8. If any member believes that the Provincial Superior is interfering with civil or canonical investigations orneglecting the same, or covering up abuse, they are obliged to report it directly to the Superior General. (*VELM Art.3 §1)*
9. Allegations against a Bishop or the Superior General can be reported directly to the Holy See or through the Apostolic Nuncio. (*VELM Art.3 §3)*
10. Any member who fails to report abuse will face disciplinary actions in accordance with the Code of Canon Law (Canon 1371 §6) and the Constitutions of the Congregation.

11.9.5 Interaction with the Media

1. The Provincial Superior appoints a spokesperson for the province to address the media in case of public scrutiny.
2. No member of the staff shall address the media about any matter in alleged abuse against a child or vulnerable adult, unless designated to do so.
3. Appropriate response to a media query is to direct them to the designated spokesperson for the province preferably a lawyer.
4. The designated media spokesperson appointed by the Provincial Superior will prepare press statements to be released periodically during an investigation and its conclusion wherever necessary.

11.10 Dealing with the Accused

11.10.1 Where the Accused is Found Guilty of the Offence

1. If an offence against the accused is proved, the Provincial Superior shall take appropriate action depending on the nature and gravity of offence and damage caused to the victim.
2. Where the accused is found guilty of a grave act of sexual offence, his/her services are terminated immediately.
3. If the offence calls for mandatory reporting to the police, the Provincial Superior shall do the same as per the law.

11.10.2 Where the Accused is not Found Guilty

1. Where the accused person is found innocent, all charges are dropped and a note is made in his/her personal file.
2. The person's name and honour have to be restored if he/she was dishonoured publicly.

11.10.3 Right of Appeal

1. Aggrieved by the decision of the PSO/USO, the accused may prefer an appeal to the Provincial Superior or the local superior for appropriate action within 30 days from the date of communication of such decision.
2. Where the alleged victim feels that the decision of the PSO/USO is not fair and just, he/she may prefer an

appeal to the Provincial /local superior for appropriate punishment to the guilty.

3. An appeal may be made to the Provincial Superior against the acquittal of the accused or fine imposed on the complainant.
4. The decision of the Provincial Superior shall be final and binding on both the parties.

11.10.4 Maintenance of Records

1. The USO/PSO shall maintain a file in every case/matter it considers.
2. Each file shall contain a written description of the matter presented to the USO/PSO, a written report of the investigation conducted and the decisions/agreements/settlements arrived at in an individual case/matter.
3. The unit/province Safeguarding Officer is to ensure that all original material, evidence, reports on every case or matter it considers, is kept in a manner that ensures safety, confidentiality and availability for the future reference.
4. The files are the property of the respective Province. All records/documents,decisions/agreements/settlementspert aining to individual cases are kept confidential and shall be maintained by the concerned Province.

11.10.5 Safe Record-keeping and Data Protection

1. All safeguarding-related documents shall be stored securely (digitally encrypted or in locked physical archives).
2. Access shall be limited to authorized safeguarding personnel only.
3. Data retention shall comply with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 (India) and Church norms on confidentiality.
4. Personal data of minors and vulnerable adults shall never be shared without lawful consent and legitimate purpose.

11.11 Redressal Mechanism

11.11.1 Care for the Alleged Victims and their Families

1. The primary obligation of the Province shall be the healing and well-being of alleged victims and survivors.
2. Members shall proactively reach out to alleged victims and their families to listen with compassion and to demonstrate genuine care and responsibility.
3. The Province shall ensure provision of appropriate spiritual support to address the spiritual well-being of alleged victims and their families.
4. Measures shall be taken to protect the privacy and confidentiality of alleged victims, survivors, and their families at all stages of the process.

5. Alleged victims, survivors, and their families shall not be required to maintain confidentiality regarding their experience or disclosure.
6. Offer comprehensive support including legal aid, psychological counseling, medical care, and practical assistance (e.g., temporary housing, financial aid) to address the immediate and long-term needs of alleged victims and their families.
7. Ensure all interactions are sensitive to potential trauma experienced by victims and their families, prioritizing their safety, dignity, and autonomy.
8. Provide information about their rights and the justice process, enabling them to make informed decisions about their involvement.
9. Facilitate the creation or strengthening of peer support groups and community initiatives to reduce stigma and provide a sense of solidarity.
10. Tailor interventions to be culturally appropriate and responsive to the specific needs of diverse communities.

11.11.2 Care and Management of the Accused and the Convicted

Rehabilitation of the offender demands both compassion and caution. The balanced approach seeks to break the cycle of recidivism and promote a safer, more just society.

It requires the implementation of evidence-based programs that focus on education, vocational training, mental health

support, and addiction treatment to address the underlying factors contributing to criminal behaviour.

They need to be facilitated with responsible reintegration into society; through structured supervision, psychological healing, social reintegration, and strong community collaboration.

1. The Province shall establish a clear structural framework for the care, accompaniment, and management of accused members or associates.
2. The accused shall be temporarily restricted from all ministerial activities while allegations are being investigated.
3. Measures shall be taken to ensure physical and pastoral distance between the accused and the alleged victim within the religious community.
4. When the accused is a member of the Province, the Province shall assume responsibility for their care and provide accommodation in a safe and appropriate place.
5. Pastoral care and support shall be extended to persons associated with the accused who may be affected by the allegation.
6. Support shall be provided to community members who remain in the setting where the alleged abuse occurred.
7. An agreed and monitored Safety Plan shall be established for the accused.
8. If the accused is found innocent, appropriate steps shall be taken to restore their good name and dignity.
9. Structures and provisions shall be put in place for the long-term care and supervision of those who are

convicted through professional psychological treatment, spiritual guidance and accompaniment.

10. Never delegate the persons in unsupervised responsibilities that cater to minors or vulnerable adults.
11. Avoid entrusting them either with leadership position or as a formator.
12. In case of sexual abuse, the decision of the Dicastery for the Doctrine of the Faith (DDF) is binding.
13. When appropriate, explore restorative justice approaches that involve victims, offenders, and communities in repairing harm and promoting accountability.
14. Ensure access to quality medical and mental health services equivalent to those available to the general population.
15. Safeguard the rights of individuals throughout the legal process, ensuring fair treatment and access to legal representation.

11.12 Review

11.12.1 Accountability and External Oversight

1. The Province shall commission annual independent safeguarding audits to evaluate compliance and identify areas for improvement.
2. An annual safeguarding report summarizing trainings, prevention initiatives, and policy updates shall be prepared and shared with stakeholders, maintaining confidentiality of persons involved.

11.12.2 Evaluation and Monitoring

The Provincial Superior of Hyderabad Province, will be committed to the ongoing monitoring and evaluation of the procedures and behaviour protocols for the protection of children and vulnerable adults. The PSC of the province is responsible for the timely reviews of the policy.

1. Every year, each Unit will undertake a risk assessment and incorporate the mitigating measures as per the policy requirement.
2. Conduct annual safeguarding audits in all the institutions.
3. Gather feedback from all the stake holders to identify areas for improvement.
4. Once a year, there will be an opportunity for all members, staff and volunteers to partake in self-appraisal and peer appraisal to monitor the behaviour of each other.
5. Annual report of the evaluation conducted in each Unit with regard to compliance of this policy shall be submitted to the Provincial Superior every year through the Safeguarding Officers of each Unit.
6. Audit the implementation of the government policies in all the institutions of the Province.
7. The PSC shall develop measurable Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) for safeguarding (e.g., percentage of trained personnel, audit completion, policy review frequency).

8. The safeguarding policy shall undergo a comprehensive review every three years, or earlier if required by changes in law or Church norms.

12. Consequences for Non-Compliance to the Code of Conduct

Any member or an associate engaged in any form of abuse toward a child or a vulnerable adult could be liable to investigation and disciplinary actions besides legal consequences.

12.1 Sexual abuse committed by a member of the Province toward a child or vulnerable person can be dismissed from the service of ministry and face legal consequences.

12.2 Sexual abuse committed by a member of the Province toward another member of the Province with asymmetrical power due to age and authority can be dismissed from the service of ministry and face legal consequences according to Canon and Civil Law.

12.3 Any kind of abuse among the members of equal power is prohibited and are liable to disciplinary actions.

12.4 Breach of confidentiality is a crime and could face consequences according to Canon Law.

Once the USC submits its report to the PSO, the PSO has to decide the next course of action. The PSO shall be assisted by the PSC, to recommend an appropriate action. The type of investigation and the course of action may be determined by the

Provincial Superior with the advice of PSC. It may include the following:

12.4.1 Warning letter.

12.4.2 Suspension with or without pay.

12.4.3 Withholding one time/all future increments or promotion.

12.4.4 They need to be kept away from the children if they have the tendency of abusing the minors.

12.4.5 Termination of service.

12.4.6 Mandatory Reporting to the civil authorities.

13.Policy Declaration

Conscious of our responsibility before God, the Church, and the society; and faithful to the charism entrusted to us, we affirm that safeguarding is an integral part of our mission and ministry.We, the members of Hyderabad Province, are committed to protecting the rights and dignity of children and vulnerable adults, and hence we declare that:

13.1 We recognize the dignity of every human person and treat everyone with respect.

13.2 We work toward ensuring a safe environment for all minors and vulnerable adults.

13.3 We recognize the effect of abuse upon the victims and their families and respond with compassion and justice.

13.4 We care for the privacy of those who raise concern or bring allegations, and respond actively.

13.5 We abide by the norm of mandatory reporting of child abuse and abuse of vulnerable adults to the appropriate civil and ecclesiastical authorities, and deal with the allegations promptly.

13.6 We commit ourselves to the principles of responsibility, compliance, accountability, and transparency.

13.7 We collaborate with the Church, the government, the networking agencies, and communities to prevent any kind of abuse of children and vulnerable adults.

13.8 We strive to adhere to the safeguarding principles of justice, equity, solidarity, and responsibility.

13.9 We ensure regular evaluation of our safeguarding practices.

Date of approval :02.02.2026

Date of review : 02.02.2029

Signature of the Provincial Superior: 

14.Conclusion

What are stated in this policy are only bare guidelines to safeguard Children and Vulnerable Adults from all forms of abuse and maltreatment. What is more important is to spread awareness of the seriousness of abuse and maltreatment among all to all members of the JMJ, temporarily professed religious, formees at various levels of formation, lay collaborators, all employees, volunteers, associates, visitors, guests, parents & students involved in the ministries or apostolates under the responsibility of the province.

Our first priority is to prevent any form of abuse of children and vulnerable adults in all our Units. This policy emphasizes the need of safeguarding children and vulnerable adults from all forms of abuse and maltreatment for which, the preventive mechanisms shall be used very carefully. The policy also provides guidelines in case of sexual abuse or maltreatment of children and vulnerable adults takes place in any of the Units. It is not an all- inclusive and exhaustive procedure. Many a time, the nature or gravity of the offence alleged will determine the course of procedure that may be adopted. In grave matters, appropriate legal advice and assistance need to be obtained by the authorities concerned. It is the bounden duty of every member to live an exemplary life so that no such allegation of offence is made against the institute.

ANNEXURE – 1

Self-Declaration

I, _____(name), S/o _____ (Father's/Husband's name) aged_____years, resident of _____ _____

(Name of the village /road no. and Post office, name of the Police station and district and state) do hereby solemnly affirm and declare as follows:

1. That I am an applicant to the post of _____ in _____ _____(name of the institution) and I have been selected for the same post.
2. That I know that being a _____ in the Institution, I have to deal with vulnerable groups, and I am aware of the policy relating to safeguarding minors and vulnerable adults to which I have been appointed.
3. That I shall behave with children and vulnerable adults with utmost respect and will not in any way behave in any sexually exploitative and abusive manner with them.
4. That in case of any allegation of misconduct is brought against me and it is found to be true, I will be dismissed from my present employment with immediate effect.
5. That I have not been accused in the past of any offences under Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012, the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015, The Sexual Harassment

of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition, and Redressal) Act 2013 and any other sexual and/or violent crimes under any other Act currently in force.

6. That I have no criminal cases pending against me in any courts in India or elsewhere.
7. That I have not been convicted of any offences by any courts in India.
8. That I have read the contents of this affidavit and understood the same are true to the best of my knowledge and belief.

SWORN TO BEFORE ME

Place:
Date:
Deponent:

ANNEXURE - 2

UNDERTAKING REGARDING PREVENTION OF SEXUAL ABUSE BY ALL THE STAFF MEMBERS (EXISTING AND NEWLY APPOINTED)

I _____ a staff member of _____ have read and understood the institution's policy for safeguarding of the children and vulnerable adults from sexual abuse. I hereby affirm that I agree to abide by the said policy and guidelines. In case of any violations of the said policy in my direct and indirect interactions with the children and the vulnerable adults, I will be solely responsible and the institution will have no liability of my actions. In case of any violations of the said policy, the institution may terminate my employment/association and/or take suitable disciplinary and/or legal actions as per the applicable laws and rules of the country and the state. In furtherance of my resolve to adhere to this policy in the performance of my duties, I: -

1. Treat all children and vulnerable adults with respect regardless of race, color, gender, language, religion, political or other opinion, national ethnic, or social origin and disability.
2. Avoid private or secluded interactions with children and vulnerable adults.
3. Ensure that all trips, rides, vacations, camps, and other such activities minors and vulnerable adults have the

approval of the parents/guardians and/or the appropriate institution prior to the activity.

4. Maintain appropriate boundaries and avoiding dependency or favoritism.
5. Avoid being over involved or spending a great deal of time with any one child/vulnerable adult.
6. Do not provide children/vulnerable adult with alcoholic beverages, tobacco, drugs or anything that is prohibited by law.
7. Do not contact children and vulnerable adults by phone or email or social media unless necessary. My primary contact will be with the parents/guardians of the children/vulnerable adult.
8. Do not discuss such topics with children or vulnerable adults or use vocabulary, recordings, films, games or computer software or any other form of personal interaction or entertainment that is not used comfortably in the presence of the parents/adults.
9. Never show sexually explicitly or pornographic materials to children and vulnerable adult.
10. Do not make comments of a sexual nature even as jokes with children and vulnerable adult.
11. Do not engage in any physical punishment of any child in public or private.
12. Use touch only as appropriate and as accepted by the culture of the place.

13. Do not undermine the parent's authority by ridiculing parent's beliefs or allowing children to do anything against the wishes of their parents.
14. Do never ask a child to keep secrets from his or her parent.
15. Do not make any sexual advances and various types of inappropriate physical contact and any form of sexual harassment.
16. Do not make any request to children or vulnerable adults for sexual favors in return for some benefit.
17. Do not use language that will mentally or emotionally abuse the child or the vulnerable adults.
18. Do not take photographs of children or vulnerable adults while they are nude, partially nude or undressing.
19. Do not suggest inappropriate behaviour or relationship of any kind with a child or vulnerable adult.
20. Do not engage in any sexual conversation or discussion about sexual activities unless it is part of a legitimate lesson and discussion approved for teaching sexuality issues.
21. Do not expose areas of my body considered private, in an inappropriate manner in the presence of children and vulnerable adults.

I understand that in the discharge of my duties the responsibility lies on me, as a staff member of _____, to use common sense and avoid

actions or behaviours that could be construed as sexual abuse of a child or vulnerable adult.

Signature of the Staff:

Name:
Date:

Signature of the USO with seal
Name:
Date:

ANNEXURE - 3

Reporting Form

Preliminary Remark: Any complaint should be formally received by filling in the complaint form (available on the website) by the complainant or the trusted adult preferred by the child or the safeguarding contact person, if the child cannot write. The filled-in form must be given to the Unit safeguarding officer and the anonymous complaints must not be ignored.

Date of Report:
Time of Report:
Details of Complainant
Name of the Complainant:
Address:
Telephone/Mobile No.:
Email:
Relation to the Alleged Victim:
Details of Alleged Victim (Child or Vulnerable Adult)
Name:
Gender:
Date of Birth:
Address:
Social Status:
Mother Tongue:
Preferred Language of Communication:
School (if applicable):
Any Disability:

Details of the Parent/Guardian (where appropriate)

Name:

Address:

Telephone/Mobile no.:

Are Parents/Legal Guardian Aware of the Complaint:

Details of the Accused (Alleged abuser)

Name:

Address:

Relation to Child/Vulnerable adult:

Occupation:

Details of Incident

Date of Incident:

Time of Incident:

Place of Incident:

Names of Witnesses (if known):

Is the alleged victim aware of the concern being raised:

Description or Circumstances of the Abuse in Words of the Complainant:

Name of the USO:

Signature:

Mobile no.:

Email Address:

Date:

Name of the PSO:

Signature:

Mobile no.:

Email address:

Date:

ANNEXURE - 4

Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph- Hyderabad Province
Safeguarding Commission Oath of Commitment

In the Presence of God and all those present here, I _____ the member of the HyderabadProvince(unit)Safeguarding Commission solemnly swear to safeguard the dignity and rights of all the people especially of minors and vulnerable adults within our institution. I promise unwavering commitment to the safety, well-being, and protection of children and vulnerable adults, pledge to create a safe environment and pronounce zero tolerance to every form of abuse.

I _____ guarantee to handle all information regarding children and vulnerable adults with the utmost confidentiality and respect, and act with diligence, compassion and integrity. I affirm to respect the privacy and dignity of those we serve and their families unless my office or the law demands reporting to the appropriate authority. I declare to abide by the values of responsibility, accountability, transparency and compliance according to the Safeguarding Policy of the Hyderabad Province in the spirit of the Universal Church.

Signature:
Date:

Signature of the ProvincialSuperior:

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Vos Estis Lux Mundi. Vatican City, 7 May 2019.

The letter C: Stands for care.

The caring hand: Reminds us of our commitment toward the children and persons in vulnerable situations.

The letter D: Stands for dignity.

Human character with raised hands: Represents a liberated human person created in the image and likeness of God. We recognise this inherent dignity of the person irrespective of circumstances.

The letters JMJ: Represent all the members of the Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph and the associates.

The colours: Represent care, dignity and positivity.
Pink represents care.
Greyish blue represents dignity.
Orange represents positivity.



Every person has the right to life and dignity. The Congregation of Jesus Mary Joseph, Hyderabad Province ensures the safety of all minors and vulnerable persons by establishing Safeguarding guidelines that would be implemented in all its apostolic activities and within the communities. The guidelines and the standards provide the framework for safeguarding practices.

The guidelines express the commitment of the Province by raising awareness on the seriousness of the abuse of minors and vulnerable persons, responding to the victims and their families, working with communities, safe recruitment, establishing procedures to manage allegations, formation and training, accountability and continuous assessment. The standards enable us to reach the expected level of performance and remain vigilant in safeguarding children and vulnerable persons. The members of the Province, its associates, employees, and volunteers abide by these principles and protect the integrity of the Province, the church, and its mission.

-Safeguarding Comission
Hyderabad Province

JMJ Provincialate
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Raj Bhavan Road,
Hyderabad - 500082